

CRUM Account of FEAR

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I. CRUM ACCOUNT OF FEAR

The CRUM account of fear within the lecture revolves around the example where you are walking alone at night down a dark alley. In this event, you suddenly hear footsteps and you perceive the events through auditory inputs of the footsteps and the visual input of the dark alley. This gives the cognitive understanding that someone is standing behind you, which gives you the response of danger or fear. This account from class discusses 4 different theories of emotion of how this event can be experienced [2].

The James-Lange Theory posits that an emotion comes from a physiological response. In this example, you hear the footsteps which insights your heart to race. Your body noticed the changes and interprets it as fear [1]. The Cannon-Bard Theory states that both the physiological response and the emotional feeling occurs at the same time, so your heart races and you feel fear simultaneously [1]. The Schachter-Singer Theory explains that the emotion arise from a combination of physiological arousal combined with a cognitive label [1]. The example would follow the sequence of you hearing footsteps, your heart races, you asks yourself why your heart is racing, you understand it's because someone might be behind you, and then you would feel fear. The Lazarus Theory has a sequence in which the physiological response and the emotion occurs at the same time but has a cognitive appraisal between the event and any results [3]. You would interpret the situation as dangerous, and this would trigger a bodily response as well as the emotion of fear.

II. THE EMOTION "FEAR"

A. Fearful Situations

Fear is an emotion that I personally have not experienced too often. However, there have been situations in which I was fearful. The most prominent of which is where I am high up in the air. In addition, I have also been involved in a vehicular accident before, and my emotion during the collision can be determined to be fearful.

B. Situation 1 Analysis

The second scenario where I was in a car accident can best be explained to fit the Cannon-Bard theory. Unlike the previous context, a car accident is an almost instantaneous event in which everything occurs immediately. In this example, my physiological responses during a car accident, such as body tensing and high heart rate occurs immediately along with the emotion of fear. The immediate threat of bodily harm is a

reaction that comes together with the physical responses of the body.

C. Situation 2 Analysis

The second scenario where I was in a car accident can best fit the Cannon-Bard theory. A car accident is an almost instantaneous event in which everything occurs immediately. In this example, my physiological responses during a car accident, such as body tensing and high heart rate occurs immediately along with the emotion of fear. The immediate threat of bodily harm is a reaction that comes together with the physical responses of the body.

III. CRUM ACCOUNT OF ANGER

For my CRUM account of anger, I chose to use an example that I believe almost everyone would have experienced so it would be the most relatable and understandable. In this example, you are driving on the street at the speed limit when a car speeds by you and immediately cuts you off from your lane almost causing a car crash. In this example, you perceive the events occurring visually and can cognitively understand that the situation that occurred is dangerous and wrongful towards you. This would incite a response of anger.

Following the example from fear, this example can be discussed using the 4 theories. For the James-Lange Theory, the physiological response would be heart rate raising and muscle tensing. The emotion registered from the response would be anger from the sudden trigger. The Cannon-Bard Theory has the output with the feeling of anger and the body reactions at the same time instead. The Schachter-Singer Theory has a sequence in which the arousal leads to a cognitive interpretation of the arousal due to the endangerment of the driver due to negligence resulting in anger. Finally, looking at the Lazarus Theory, the representation would be the car swerving in front of you and the computation of your appraisal of the context as dangerous and unfair, which triggers the emotion of anger [1].

IV. THE EMOTION "ANGER"

A. Angering Situations

Personally, I believe that I can be quick to anger on specific instances. For example, I am very protective of my family and friends, which can lead me to anger when someone bullies them. Also, I focus on efficiency in work, and there have been times in which I have been pushed to anger when coworkers have purposely wasted my time on unnecessary things. Both of these situations are known to draw out my emotion of anger.

B. Situation 1 Analysis

The first situation I believe can be relatable to many other people. The Schachter-Singer theory perfectly explains the sequence of the process. The representation would be a friend being bullied, which leads to the physiological arousal of tense muscles and raised adrenaline. The computation would be the cognitive label of processing why am I aroused and the revelation that my friend is being hurt, which finally leads to the emotion of anger.

C. Situation 2 Analysis

The second situation aligns better with the Lazarus theory in which the stimulus, which is a coworker wasting my time, leads to a cognitive appraisal. This would be computed as a unfair or unreasonable act, which in turn would result in the emotion of anger and the physical body responses such as urges to yell.

V. COMMON PATTERNS BETWEEN FEAR AND ANGER

Fear and anger are both emotions that can be analyzed in the CRUM language. Looking at both emotions and context that I have experienced. They heavily involved in external stimuli that can also trigger significant bodily responses and can be evaluated as harmful to oneself. Fear can be linked towards harm and danger, while anger can be linked to harm in fairness and justice. These emotions are caused by events that can also lead to similar physical reactions such as tension and elevated heart rate. Overall, both fear and anger can ultimately be seen as a computational appraisal of harm either physically or mentally.

REFERENCES

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